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Are You In Suspense?

Are you wondering what happened to your order or payment, even after a fortnight? But did you mention your name and address clearly while sending payment, and what the payment was for?

We get several payments every month without adequate instructions or even identity of the person sending the payment. As a result we are unable to take appropriate action on these, till we get a complaint - if at all.

At EFY, we want you to be our satisfied customer. So please do let us know in case your payment or instructions are not even acknowledged within a fortnight. We are not that lazy!

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EFYGROUP
Technology Drives Us

According to Jim Zemlin, executive director at The Linux Foundation, "The response to our first edX course was powerful, demonstrating the understanding among students and early career professionals all over the world that open source is the pathway to a lucrative career in technology." He added that through the introduction to cloud infrastructure technologies, anybody can start learning the basics of building and managing some of today's most pervasive software, thus granting professionals a strong position in the IT talent market.

LFS151, which is what the course is called, will offer a primer on cloud computing and the use of open source software to maximise development and operations. The course will cover next-generation cloud technologies including Docker, CoreOS, Kubernetes and OpenStack. It will offer an overview of software-defined storage and networking solutions, along with a review of DevOps and continuous integration best practices.

The course has twelve chapters. Each chapter has a short quiz at the end. One also needs to take a final exam for completing the course. Students can take the complete course at no cost, or add a verified certificate of completion for US\$ 99.

Microsoft to open source Minecraft based AI platform

Microsoft plans to open source its AI platform, which is based on Minecraft. Microsoft will be open sourcing a platform that is being used by researchers for testing in artificial intelligence projects. The AIX platform is already being utilised by Microsoft researchers. It permits researchers to utilise the unstructured play in the Minecraft game as a testing ground for AI research.



AIX is going to be open sourced by summer this year under an open source licence. The announcement has come at a time when Google DeepMind has gained attention for the Go games, which are being played by its AI program AlphaGo with a key Go player, Lee Se-dol. AlphaGo has won three straight games of the five-game match in Seoul, losing one to Se-dol.

With AIX, Microsoft is focusing on projects which involve general intelligence. Microsoft feels it "...is more similar to the nuanced and complex way humans learn and make decisions."

According to Allison Linn, a senior writer at Microsoft, AI researchers are developing tools which involve recognising words, for example. However, researchers are not being able to combine these skills effortlessly as humans do.

Microsoft had acquired Mojang, the developer of Minecraft, in 2014. Linn also stated that the AIX platform, which was developed by Microsoft's lab in Cambridge, UK, comprises a 'mod' for the Java version and code, which assists artificial intelligence agents to sense and act within the Minecraft environment. Both these components are capable of running on Windows, Linux or Mac OS, and researchers can use any programming language to program their agents.